

Ava Frohna

TECHNOLOGY • CYBERSECURITY • PRODUCT & PROJECT DELIVERY

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PROFILE

Penultimate-year Master of Computer Science student majoring in Cybersecurity (Nov 2027), Technical Lead & Co-Founder of NORA, and recipient of the University of Sydney Engineering Vacation Research Internship Program Scholarship. Combines secure full-stack and cloud engineering, AI security research, data pipelines, product strategy, project delivery, and risk management with commercial awareness gained helping start and run a company in a regulated market. Fast learner who translates unfamiliar technical and business domains into working systems and clear decisions across multidisciplinary teams.

EXPERIENCE

Technical Lead & Co-Founder — NORA, Sydney

Apr 2026 – Present

- Design and build the full technical surface of an Azure-hosted clinical communication platform: Fastify/PostgreSQL backend, React nurse dashboard, React Native (Expo) patient app, and provider-agnostic AI adapters; own system architecture, integration, and secure product delivery.
- Co-founded and help run a three-person venture, developing product strategy and startup operations while translating clinical, user, business, cybersecurity, and regulatory requirements into prioritised decisions; communicate technical and commercial trade-offs across disciplines.
- Established risk and compliance groundwork for a regulated medical-software pathway: ISO 14971 risk management, ISO 27001 information security management, IEC 62304 software lifecycle, and preparation for future TGA submission.
- Rapidly learned healthcare, venture building, and regulated-software constraints; helped take NORA from founding to Global Top 20 of 1,500 Harvard Health Systems Innovation Lab teams in ten weeks, 1st place at the Sydney Hub, then represented Australia in the venture program.

Engineering Vacation Research Intern — University of Sydney

Jun 2026 – Present

Engineering Vacation Research Internship Program Scholarship (SC4282)

- Selected for a merit-based Faculty of Engineering scholarship to conduct faculty-supervised security research in an emerging area of agentic AI, rapidly synthesising academic and technical evidence into a focused research direction and clear risk framing.
- Build reproducible pipelines to organise public CVE evidence for structured human validation, with provenance and quality controls; detailed objectives, methods, scale, and findings remain private pending publication.

Web Developer — You Belong San Diego (non-profit)

Jun 2026 – Present

- Design and build the organisation's digital platform and online presence, translating a community mission into user-focused information architecture and outreach that helps San Diego residents find belonging.
- Contribute across web development, content, and social channels, adapting quickly to move an early-stage, purpose-led initiative forward.

Mobile Expert — T-Mobile

May 2025 – Jan 2026

- Delivered customer-facing technology support in high-volume operations, diagnosing device and service issues and translating complex fixes for non-technical customers to drive first-contact resolution.
- Learned changing products, workflows, and internal systems quickly; trained and supported new team members to improve team consistency and service quality.

SELECTED PROJECTS

AI-Based Clinical Decision Support System — Pilot Deployment Plan

Feb – May 2026

INFO6007 Project Management in IT, University of Sydney — Best Project Award

- Led a five-person cross-functional team as Project Manager to produce the complete development and pilot-deployment plan for an AI-based clinical decision support system integrating with hospital EMR systems.
- Built the project and program-delivery foundation: charter, governance and RACI, scope and WBS, critical-path schedule, and costed AUD 650K budget with phased funding and contingency reserves.
- Created the risk register, PDCA/DMAIC quality plan, supplier evaluation, communication and change plans, and earned-value monitoring; coordinated cybersecurity, privacy, and clinician-adoption workstreams.

Open-Source Exploit Prediction Scoring System (EPSS) | [GitHub](#)

Feb – Jul 2025

Bachelor Thesis, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

- Designed a data-ingestion and feature-engineering pipeline for 9,645 CVEs from six public sources, combining CVSS metrics, community threat intelligence, social signals, and SentenceBERT embeddings.
- Trained and evaluated a neural-network classifier achieving 90.37% match to official risk categories, translating complex data into transparent, automated vulnerability prioritisation.
- Collaborated in a four-person research team across data collection, modelling, validation, analysis, and documentation; published the work as an open-source alternative to proprietary scoring.

EDUCATION

Master of Computer Science (Major: Cybersecurity) — University of Sydney

Feb 2026 – Nov 2027

Coursework: Introduction to Cybersecurity; Project Management in IT; Professional Practice in IT; Cybersecurity.

Activities: Women in Technology; Cyber Security Society; Women in Engineering Society.

Bachelor of Computer Science — Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

Aug 2022 – Jul 2025

Focus: Operating Systems; Data Structures & Algorithms; Security & Safety Engineering; Cloud Computing; Digital Health Software.

Exchange: University of Queensland, Brisbane — Information Security; Cloud Computing; Mobile Programming.

CAPABILITIES

Technology & Engineering: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, C/C++, SQL; React, React Native, Fastify, PostgreSQL; full-stack engineering, secure APIs, system architecture, digital platforms and products.

Cloud, Data & Emerging Tech: Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud Platform, Docker, Kubernetes, Unix/Linux, distributed systems, data platforms and pipelines, neural networks, embeddings, LLM integration.

Cyber, Risk & Governance: Cyber risk management, vulnerability assessment, threat modelling, secure software development, ISO 27001, ISO 14971, IEC 62304, TGA regulatory groundwork.

Strategy & Delivery: Product strategy, innovation, project and program management, governance, RACI, WBS/CPM, EVM, risk registers, commercial awareness, stakeholder communication, cross-functional leadership.

Professional Focus: Secure product engineering, cloud and data platforms, AI security, technology risk, digital transformation, commercial awareness, and project delivery.

RECOGNITION

Global Top 20 Demo Day Finalist — Harvard Health Systems Innovation Lab Venture Building Program (Jun 2026)

1st Place, Sydney Hub — Harvard Health Systems Innovation Lab Hackathon (Apr 2026)

Best Project Award — INFO6007 Project Management in IT, University of Sydney (Jun 2026)

Engineering Vacation Research Internship Program Scholarship (SC4282) — University of Sydney (Jun 2026)